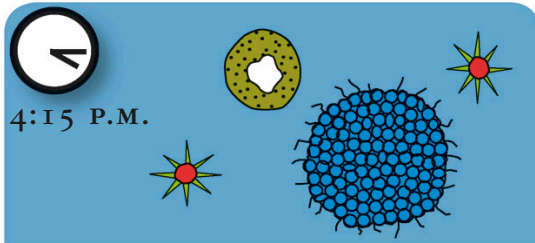




On this time scale, *every minute* is equivalent to *3.2 million years*.

1,500 million years ago



GETTING COMPLICATED

Multicellular life forms emerge. Some of these will go on to be the ancestors of all plants, fungi, and animals. There's not much land above the waves so life stays in the water, but there's lots more oxygen in the atmosphere.

700 million years ago



SNOWBALL EARTH

Lichens and simple plants start to grow inland. Unfortunately the climate turns extremely chilly and the whole planet becomes a snowball. A few hardy species survive on land and in deep water.

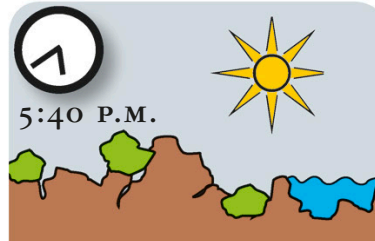
11:00 12:00 13:00 14:00 15:00 16:00 17:00 18:00 19:00 20:00 21:00



COMPLEX CELLS

The first complex eukaryotes appear. It's still hard for life to survive outside of the water because of the deadly effect of the Sun's radiation. Protective ozone starts to build up in the atmosphere.

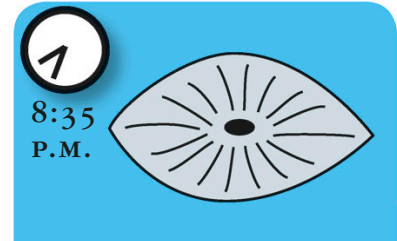
1,850 million years ago



MOVING OUT

Organisms begin to get a bit more adventurous. Fungi and multicelled green algae venture out of the shallows to the fringes of the land. Life's a beach.

1,200 million years ago



A SOFT LIFE

As things warm up again, a whole new set of soft-bodied animals evolve that are larger and more diverse than before. These include primitive sponges and jellyfish.

630 million years ago